
Best Short Film
Kolkata International Short Film Festival
2025
Best Short Film
Pakistan International Film Festival
2025
BEST DIRECTOR
AWARD
Gandhara Independent Film Festival 2025 (Online)
OFFICIAL SELECTION
Kosovo Young Filmmakers Festival
KYFF
2025
OFFICIAL SELECTION
Gandhara Independent Film Festival
2025
Kinofestival "Light of the world"
FINALIST
2026
BEST FILM
AWARD
Gandhara Independent Film Festival 2025 (Online)
OFFICIAL SELECTION
Islamabad International Film Festival
2025
OFFICIAL SELECTION
Urbanite Arts & Film Festival
2025
Best Director
Kolkata International Short Film Festival
2025
WINNER
BEST TRAILER
TMFF
THE MONTHLY FILM FESTIVAL
2025
OFFICIAL SELECTION
Toronto Fantasy/Sci-Fi Film & Screenplay Festival
2025
Best Director
Indus Film Festival
2025
CEDAR FILM FESTIVAL 2026
BEST DIRECTOR
2026
CEDAR FILM FESTIVAL 2026
BEST FILM
2026
CINEGMA FILMS
PRESENTS
جنجال
A FILM BY SYED ASAD
CINEGMA FILMS PRESENTS JANJAAL A FILM BY SYED ASAD PRODUCED BY FAIZAN AHMED WRITTEN BY AMEER HAMZA STARRING SHAMOON ABBASI, NAZISH ALI, DANISH IRSHAD DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY GHAYAS UDDIN SIDDIQUI PRODUCTION DESIGNER AIZA AHMED MUSIC BY HASSAN KHAN
SCREENPLAY BY AMEER HAMZA AND SYED ASAD ART DIRECTOR ABDUL BASIT ASSISTANT DIRECTOR BASIL HUSSAIN ZAIDI EDITED BY SYED ASAD
ASSOCIATES DAYYAN KHALID AND S M SAAD ALI SPECIAL EFFECTS BY FAIZAN AHMED SECOND UNIT DOP AMMAR IMRAN BHATTI

A CINEGMA FILMS PRODUCTION

JANJAAL

(TUSSLE)

What would you sacrifice to change fate?

2024	URDU	24 MIN	PSYCHOLOGICAL THRILLER	PAKISTAN

Directed by Syed Asad Raza Abidi

Starring Shamoon Abbasi

14	22	9	34 hrs
INTERNATIONAL AWARDS	OFFICIAL SELECTIONS	COUNTRIES	TO SHOOT

LOGLINE

A police officer discovers a cursed golden pocket watch that grants wishes, but each wish comes with deadly consequences.

SYNOPSIS

A fisherman, Azad, is found alive on a boat filled with dead bodies. He is brought in for interrogation by Raza, a police officer, who discovers a golden antique pocket watch on Azad. The watch is believed to grant wishes, but with a dark twist. Raza dismisses the idea, but when he wishes for money, he experiences a strange force.

THEMES

Grief and desperation. How far a parent will go when faced with unbearable loss.

Temptation and greed. A golden watch that cuts the hand that takes it.

Fate and consequence. Getting exactly what you asked for is the worst thing that can happen.

DIRECTOR'S STATEMENT

> *"Janjaal is a story about grief, desperation, and the dangerous allure of desire. I wanted to explore how far someone can go when faced with unbearable loss, and how even hope can become a curse when tainted by greed. The golden pocket watch symbolizes temptation, a gift that comes with a hidden knife. My goal was to make the audience feel unsettled, to confront them with the question: What would you sacrifice to change fate?"*
>
> **Syed Asad Raza Abidi**

DIRECTOR BIOGRAPHY



Syed Asad Raza Abidi

DIRECTOR

EDITOR

FOUNDER, CINEGMA FILMS

Karachi, Pakistan

Syed Asad Raza Abidi is a Pakistani filmmaker, director, and editor, best known for his award-winning short film *Janjaal* (Tussle). Founder of Cinegma Films, Asad is recognized for his grounded storytelling and visual depth. A graduate of Indus University in Film & TV, he has directed, edited, and produced multiple independent projects, including *Portrait of Life*, noted for its introspective tone and visual poetry. Asad represents the new wave of independent Pakistani cinema.

THE PITCH

Shot in 34 hours. Seen in 9 countries.

Janjaal was filmed on a Karachi beach by a crew of film students, with cinema screens already booked for the premiere. The tide was due at 7 AM. At 9:30 the boats were still on dry sand. Then the water came, the scene was shot, and the whole film was in the can.

It opened at Arena Cinemas on 5 January 2025, a rare cinema release for a Pakistani student short. Since then it has taken Best Short Film at the Toronto Fantasy/Sci-Fi Film Festival, Best Film and Best Director at the Cedar Film Festival, and Best Director and Best Short Film in Kolkata.

34	14	9
HOURS TO SHOOT	INTERNATIONAL AWARDS	COUNTRIES

A real lead
Shamoon Abbasi plays Raza, the grieving officer at the center of the film, with Danish Irshad and Nazish Ali.

One vision
Direction, edit, VFX, colour grade and a 5.1 surround mix, all by Syed Asad Raza Abidi at Cinegma Films.

Proven on screens
Released theatrically at Arena Cinemas, Karachi, then selected and awarded across 9 countries.





ON SET

FILM DETAILS

TITLE	Janjaal (Tussle)
GENRE	Psychological thriller, Mystery
RUNTIME	24 minutes
LANGUAGE	Urdu
COUNTRY	Pakistan
YEAR	2024
PREMIERE	5 January 2025, Arena Cinemas, Karachi (theatrical)
FORMAT	Sony FX3, 2.35:1, 5.1 surround sound
DIRECTOR	Syed Asad Raza Abidi
WRITERS	Ameer Hamza, Basil Hussain Zaidi
PRODUCER	Faizan Ahmed
STARRING	Shamoon Abbasi (Raza), Danish Irshad (Azad), Nazish Ali (Zareen)
CINEMATOGRAPHY	Ghayas Uddin Siddiqui
MUSIC	Hassan Khan (Wild Media)
EDITOR / VFX / COLOUR	Syed Asad Raza Abidi
PRODUCTION	Cinegma Films

CINEGMA FILMS

Cinegma Films is an independent production company founded in January 2024 and based in Karachi. Its first production, *Janjaal*, was made entirely in-house and has since earned 14 international awards and 22 official selections across 9 countries.

FILMOGRAPHY

JANJAAL (2024)	Psychological thriller, 24 min. 14 international awards.
PORTRAIT OF LIFE (2025)	Drama about a painter who can no longer portray his wife the way he once did.
MAIN AUR ACHU (2024)	Family drama about a boy, his goat and the meaning of Eid ul Azha.
A SOLDIER BESIDE ME (2026)	War drama on loyalty, war and humanity.
PAYAM E DIL (2026)	Family drama set in the heart of Karachi.
ZAWAAL (2026)	Psychological thriller set in Karachi. In production.

AWARDS & SELECTIONS

Awards Won

AWARD	FESTIVAL	COUNTRY
Best Director	Indus Film Festival (IFF)	Pakistan
Best Director	Kolkata International Short Film Fest (KISFF)	India
Best Short Film	Kolkata International Short Film Fest (KISFF)	India
Best Short Film	Pakistan International Film Festival (PIFF)	Pakistan
Best Film	Gandhara Independent Film Festival (GIFF)	Pakistan
Best Director	Gandhara Independent Film Festival (GIFF)	Pakistan
Best Director	Cedar Film Festival 2026	Pakistan
Best Film	Cedar Film Festival 2026	Pakistan
Best Short Film	Cedar Film Festival 2026	Pakistan
Best Director	Cinephelia Flair International Film Festival, Season 06	Pakistan
Best Short Film	Toronto Fantasy/SciFi Film Festival (TFSFS)	Canada
3rd Best Short Film	KinoFest: Light of the World	Russia
Best Trailer (Janjaal)	TMFF	Scotland
Best Editing	IU Film Fest 2025	Pakistan

Official Selections & Nominations

RECOGNITION	FESTIVAL	COUNTRY
Official Selection	Islamabad International Film Festival (IIFF)	Turkey
Official Selection	Kosovo Young Filmmakers Film Festival (KYFF)	Kosovo
Official Selection	Toronto Fantasy/SciFi Film Festival (TFSFS)	Canada
Official Selection (Finalist)	Urbanite Art & Film Festival (UAFF)	New York, USA
Official Selection	Gandhara Independent Film Festival (GIFF)	Pakistan
Official Selection	CrossBorder Film Festival	Chicago, USA
Nominee	Universal Film Festival	USA
Official Selection	Festival cortos para Tiempos Largos	Spain
Official Selection	Sobh Media Festival	Iran

FESTIVAL LAURELS









JANJAAL

Screener and press materials available on request.

Syed Asad Raza Abidi

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IMDb imdb.com/title/tt35505024

FilmFreeway filmfreeway.com/SyedAsad